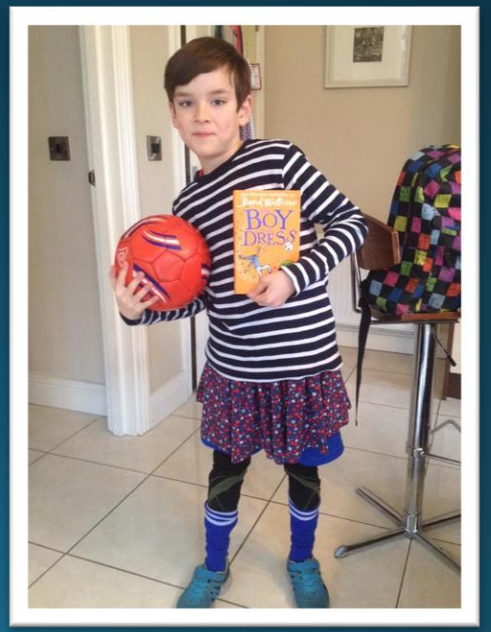


Gender Identity Development







The Self & Social Identities

Last Minute Paper Tips

- Make **one clear overall argument** about how ChatGPT interpreted your identity. Use **specific examples** from the AI interaction—not just general impressions.
- Analyze: What ChatGPT captured accurately, What it misunderstood, How the information you included—and left out—shaped its response
- Go beyond saying ChatGPT was "right" or "wrong." Explain *why* it responded as it did.
- Apply at least **three course concepts, theories, or empirical findings**. Use concepts to explain specific parts of the interaction; do not simply define them. End with broader implications for AI, identity, person perception, stereotyping, belonging, or self-presentation.



Last Minute Paper Tips

- Submit **one Word document** containing: Your original identity-prompt responses
- The complete ChatGPT interaction, including prompts and responses
- Your 4–8 page analysis
- Organize the paper around a thesis—not a list of answers to the questions. Use clear paragraphs, transitions, and section organization. Follow APA style; proofread carefully. Format: double-spaced, 12-point font, 1-inch margins. Include the required GAI acknowledgment, citations, and interaction transcript/share link.
- The biggest point areas: **course-concept integration (30 points)** and **critical analysis of the AI response (25 points)**, so prioritize those



MEDIA EXAMPLES

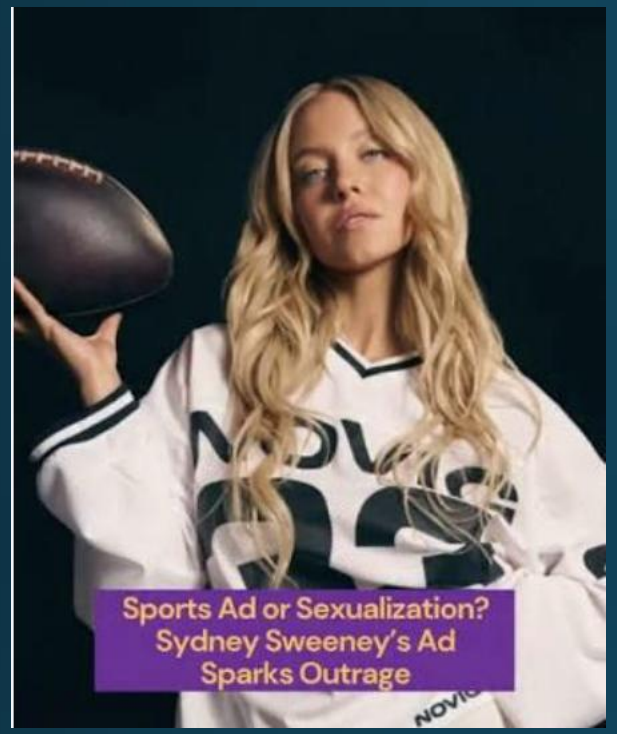


SPORTS + COLLEGE BASKETBALL +

A Little Trash Talk Is Just What Women's Basketball Needs



Angel Reese of the LSU Lady Tigers reacts towards Caitlin Clarkof the Iowa Hawkeyes during the fourth quarter during the 2023 NCAA Women's Basketball Tournament championship game at American Airlines Center in Dallas on April 2, 2023. *Maddie Meyer—Getty Images*



"Why Are Girls Mad?" – Sophie Cunningham Shares a Hot Take on Sydney Sweeney's Controversial Novig Ad

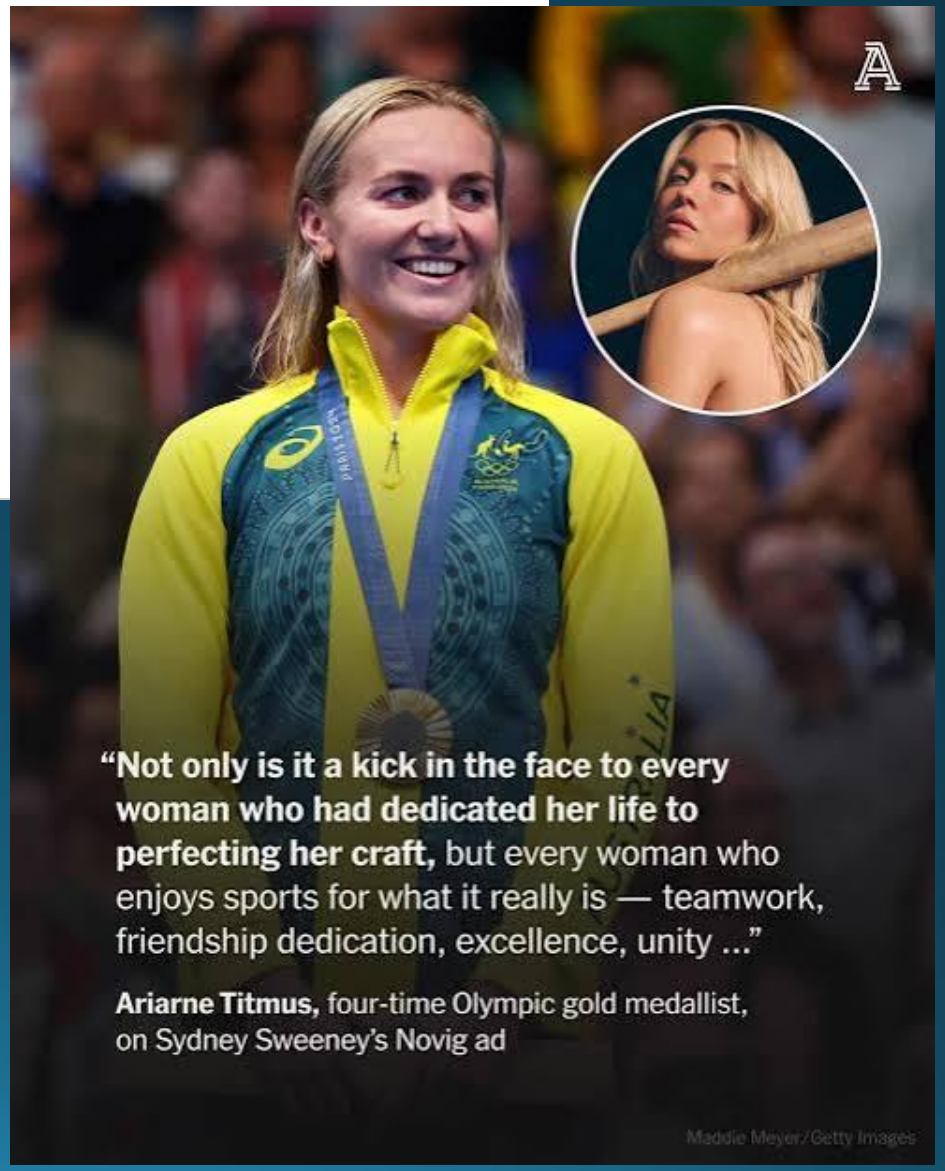
Kunal Singh
Sat, September 19, 2026 at 8:10 AM EDT · 2 min read

2

Sydney Sweeney stirred the sporting world with a controversial ad for Novig. The prediction-market platform's latest featured The Housemaid star in the most illicit way possible. While most of the female athletes across different sports were outraged, Sophie Cunningham certainly had a more mature take on the ad.

In a recent episode of her No Hesitation podcast, featuring Drew Hanlen, the WNBA star questioned, "Why are girls mad?" Defending Sweeney, the WNBA star further said, "That is literally what she does. Why is anyone mad? It is a gambling ad. Men, sports, pretty much naked women. Of course that's going to draw attention."





Defining Gender

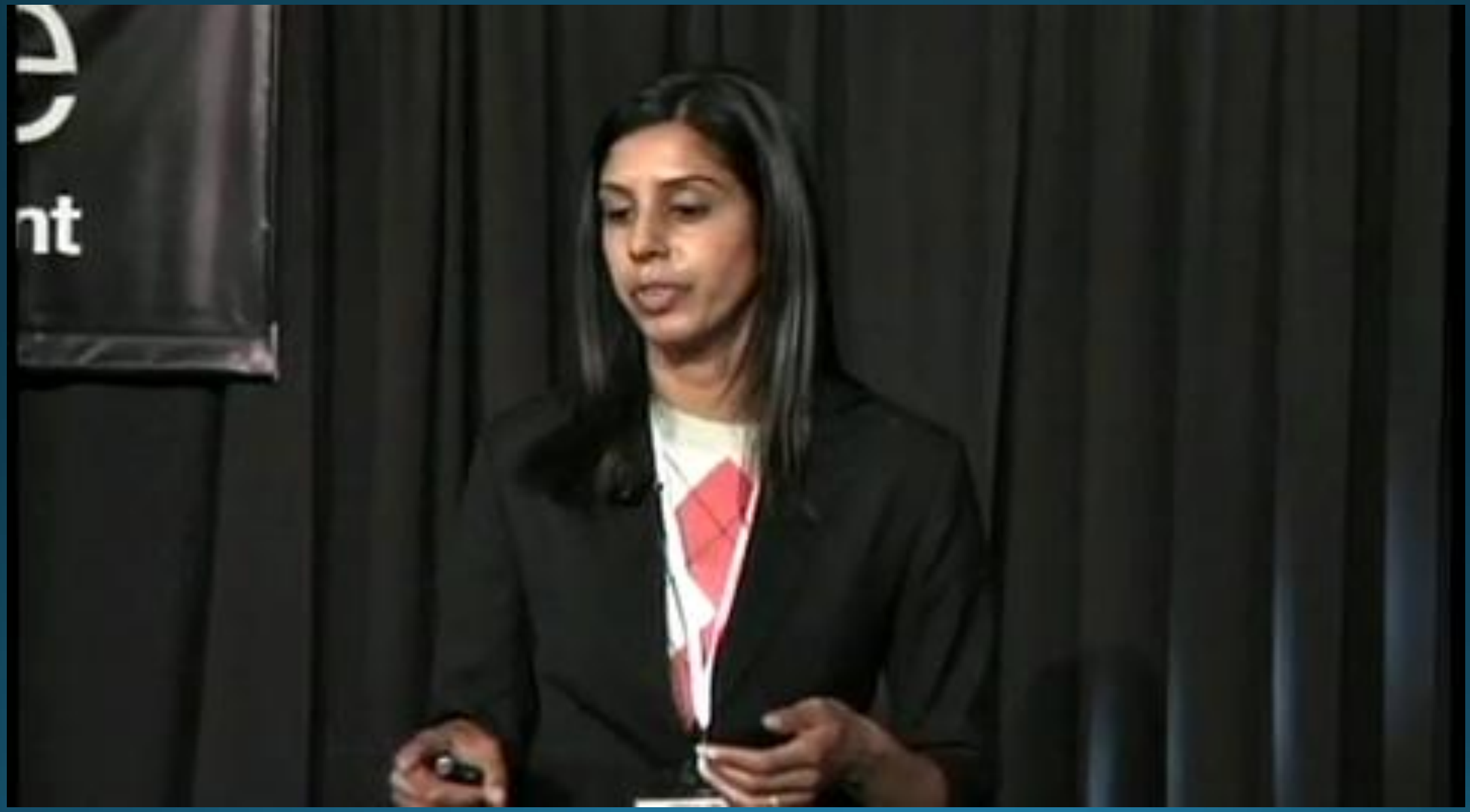
Biological sex: chromosomes, hormones , reproductive anatomy

Gender identity: internal sense of being male, female, both, neither, or another gender

Gender expression: clothes, hair, behavior, voice

Sexual orientation: separate construct

Dr. Sapna Cheryan, University of Washington



Gender Schema Theory

- Martin and Halverson (1981)
- Children pay more attention to objects and activities depending on whether that object/activity is seen as self-relevant
- In this model, judgments about self-relevance depend, first, on children's knowledge about what is culturally defined as "for girls" versus "for boys" and, second, on their self-identification as girls or boys





By preschool, children already associate many occupations with a particular gender.

Often seen as “for boys”



Firefighter



Engineer



Pilot

Often seen as “for girls”



Teacher



Nurse

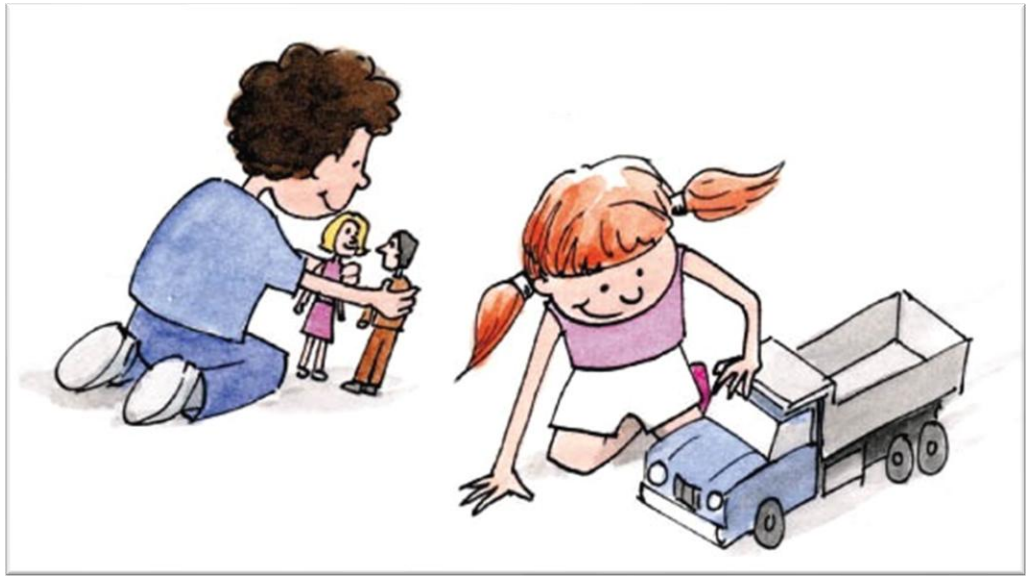


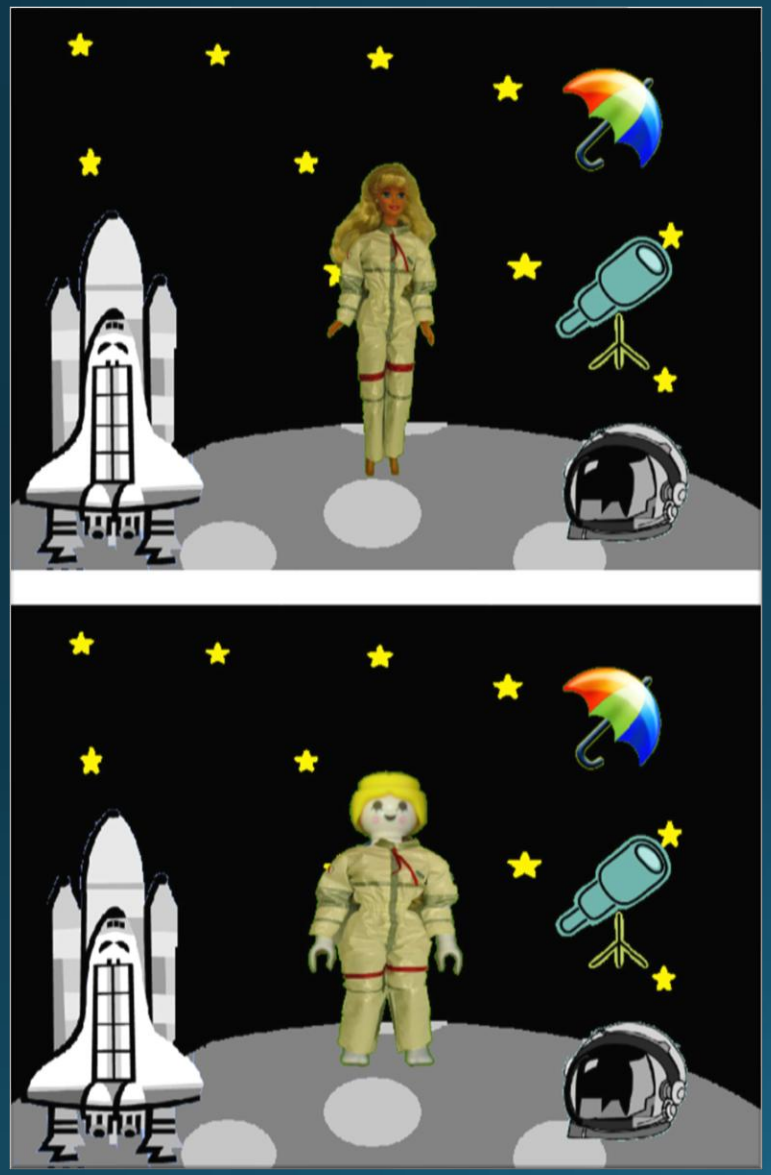
Librarian

Dual-Pathway Model (DPM) to Gender

- Attitudinal Pathway—a child's beliefs about what is culturally acceptable for girls versus boys drives the child's own involvement and actions

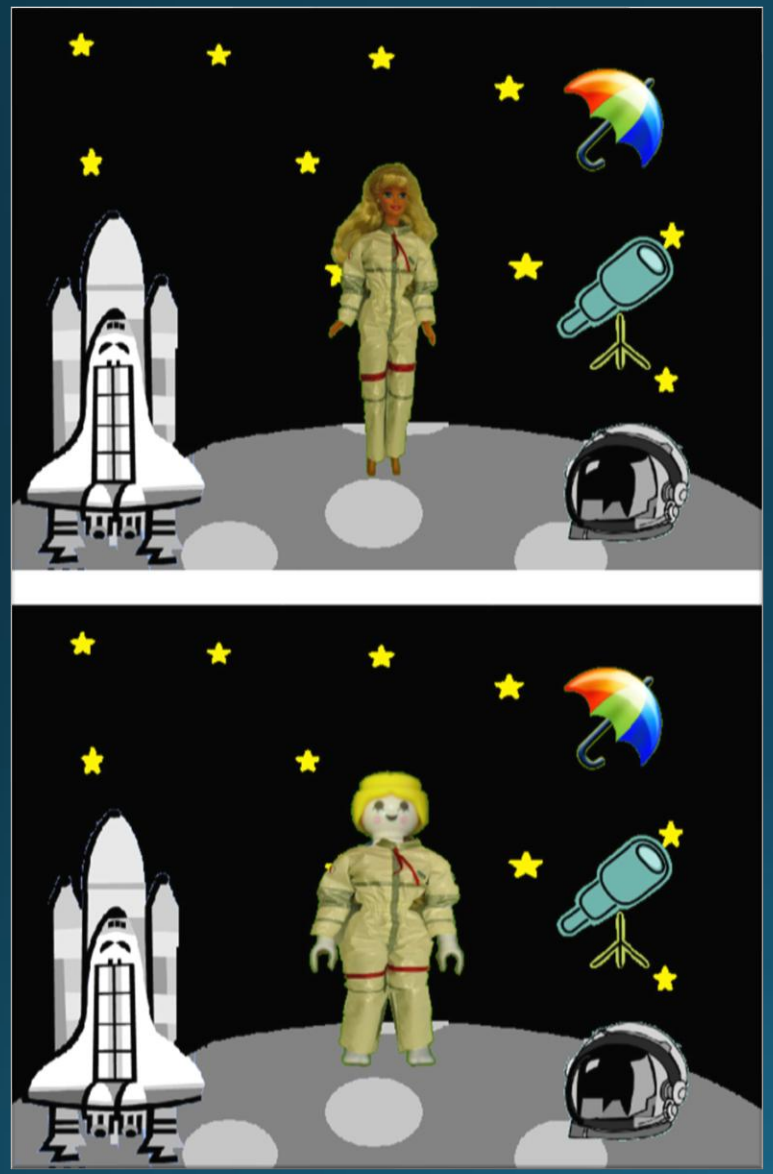
- Personal Pathway—identifies an inverse route where the child's personal interests and routine attention to gender are thought to drive development





Coyle & Liben: Gendered Occupations Study

- Research Question:
  - Test the DPM-derived hypothesis that individual differences in GSF moderate children's responses to gendered experiences
  - Can girls be attracted to jobs traditionally stereotyped as masculine?
- Method:
  - 62 girls completed 2 sessions:
    - Baseline measures of masculine and feminine activity interest
    - Computer game showing differing job framing, then interests were measured again

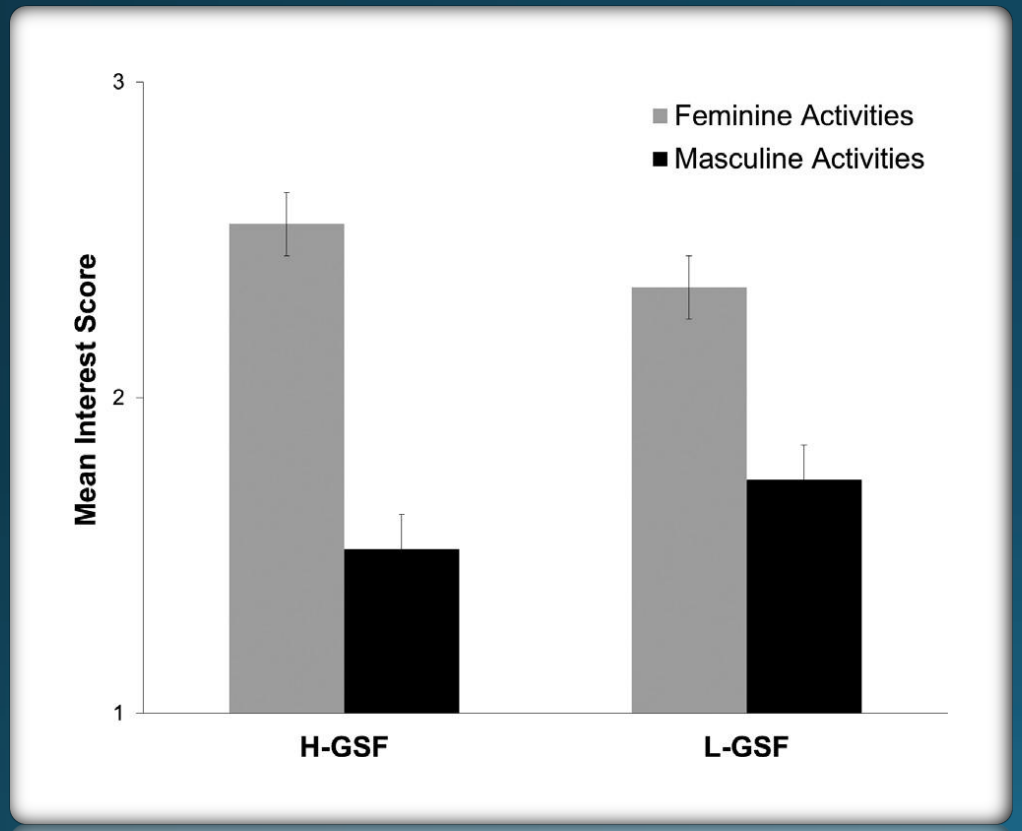


Coyle & Liben: Gendered Occupations Study

- <u>Method:</u>
  - Four traditionally feminine jobs (librarian, teacher, nurse, and florist)
  - Four traditionally masculine jobs (explorer, astronaut, firefighter, and chemist)
  - Four novel jobs (benster, hegist, silter, and tenic)

- Peer preferences task comparing photos
- Gender memory and encoding task
- Gender typicality/similarity task
- Job interests

Gendered Occupations Study: Results



- Difference in activity interest was greater for H-GSF girls than L-GSF girls
- In the Barbie condition: H-GSF girls showed intensified interests in feminine activities after game play, whereas L-GSF girls showed no such effect
- No impact on masculine job interests
- What does this mean overall? What is the take home message?

Discussion?

- What do you think could help shift girls' job aspirations? And what about for boys?
- And what about the contrast of femininity vs. being a role model?
- What variations in the context or the individual might sway these results?



Life as a Transgender Child





Olson Paper: Gender Cognition for Transgender Children

- Research question:
  - Are transgender children really confused about their gender identity compared to their natal sex? Or do their gender attitudes match their actual identification?

- Method:
  - Transgender (N = 32), Cisgender Siblings (N = 18), and Cisgender (N = 32) children ages 5-12

  - Gender Preference IAT (male/female, good/bad)
  - Gender Identity IAT (male/female, me/not me)

Olson Paper: Gender Cognition for Transgender Children

- **Method:**
  - **Explicit Gender Peer Preferences: between a boy and a girl, who would you be friends with?**

- **Explicit Object Preferences:**
  - "This is Amanda and she likes to play *flerp*. This is Andrew and he likes to play *babber*."

- **Explicit Gender Identity:**
  - Children were asked whether, on the inside, they felt like a boy, a girl, neither, or both

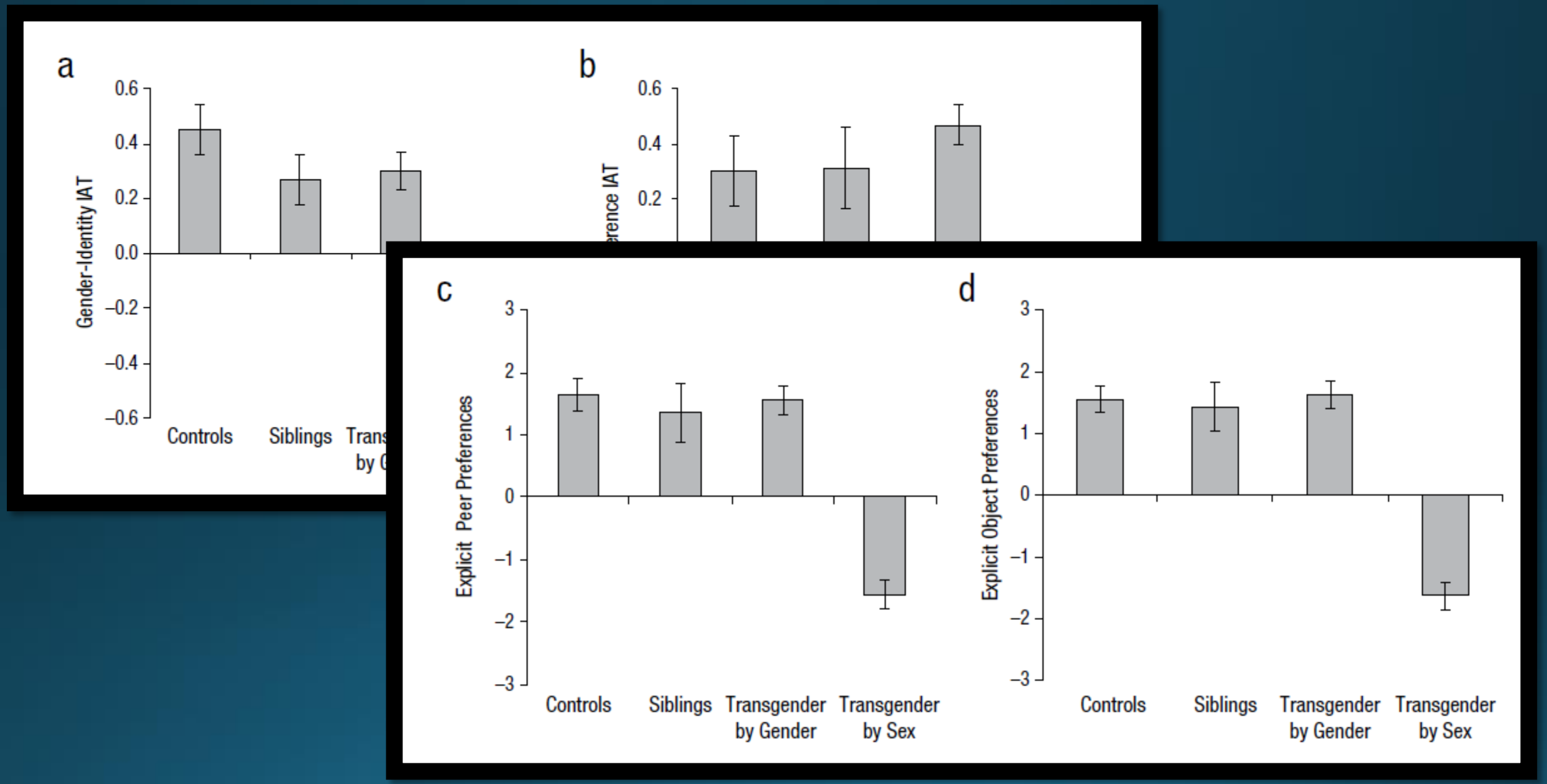




Attitudes: Implicit vs. Explicit?

Implicit Attitudes	Explicit Attitudes
Automatic	Deliberate
Non-conscious	Conscious
Less Malleable	Impacted by Context
Fast	Slow
Response Time	*Self-Report*

Results:


a
Gender-Identity IAT
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
−0.2
−0.4
−0.6
Controls
Siblings
b
0.6
0.4
0.2
c
Explicit Peer Preferences
3
2
1
0
−1
−2
−3
Controls
Siblings
Transgender by Gender
Transgender by Sex
d
Explicit Object Preferences
3
2
1
0
−1
−2
−3
Controls
Siblings
Transgender by Gender
Transgender by Sex

Gender Cognition for Transgender Children



- **Results:**
  - Transgender children viewed themselves in terms of their expressed gender and showed preferences for their expressed gender
  - Their response patterns mimicked those of cisgender (nontransgender) control groups
- **Take home message?**
  - First evidence showing early in development, transgender youth are statistically indistinguishable from cisgender children of the same gender identity—they are ***NOT*** confused

Discussion Questions

- What are some needed future directions or limitations of this study? Particularly what about the family context?
- Why might there be so much variability in gender identity development more broadly?
- If society was less gendered how might that impact the lives of transgendered individuals or any gendered person? Perceived vs. actual identity?

Next Class…

- Male Identity in College and Female Leadership + Assessing Children's Books!
- Paper 1 Due Thursday by 9am!

